War and suffrage expansion

PSCI 2227: War and State Development

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Recap

Monday: Acemoglu and Robinson on franchise expansion

- Basic obstacle to democratization: elites fear redistribution
- Two paths: popular revolt (rare) vs. elite concessions (typical)
- A&R's theory: high inequality + infrequent revolt threat $\rightsquigarrow$ temporary concessions aren't enough
- Commitment problem: promises of future redistribution aren't credible
- So elites extend the franchise instead — permanent institutional change

Today's agenda

1. Pre-war vs. post-war franchise expansion
2. Przeworski's framework: "conquered" vs. "granted"
3. Empirical predictions and data

Theories of suffrage expansion

Connecting Acemoglu and Robinson to war

Key variables in A&R's theory:

- Frequency of mass organization that could threaten elites
- Credibility of mass revolt threat
- Wealth gap between elites and masses

Discussion

How would you expect each of these to be affected when war begins? What about when a war has just ended?

Pre-war expansion: France 1792

Battle of Valmy (1792), Horace Vernet

- 1791: “Active citizen” voting (property threshold)
- 1792: Broader male suffrage
- 1793: *Levée en masse* (conscription) for war against Austria + others

Suffrage as an **inducement to fight**

Post-war expansion: Weimar Germany

Biggest increase in German suffrage came right after World War I

- October 1918: Sailors’ mutiny kicked off revolutionary discord
- November 1918: Kaiser abdicated after military defeat
- August 1919: Weimar Constitution — universal suffrage for men and women

Suffrage as a response to threat

Scheidemann declares the Republic, Nov. 1918

The strategic logic

Pre-war expansion

- Elites *choose* to expand suffrage to secure mass cooperation
- Suffrage is a bargain — rights in exchange for service

Post-war expansion

- Elites are *forced* to expand suffrage under duress
- Suffrage is a concession — the alternative is revolution
- Closer to the Acemoglu/Robinson logic

Przeworski's theory

Przeworski asks a broader question: is suffrage "conquered" or "granted"?

- "Conquered" = extended to avert forcible change in power
- "Granted" = extended voluntarily to advance elite interests

Pre-war logic is "granted," post-war logic is "conquered"

Commonalities between the two stories:

- Franchise extension is a strategic choice by elites
- Elite action, not open revolt, is typically the proximate cause

Key difference: do elites **prefer** the post-extension state of affairs over the pre-extension status quo?

Non-war motivations

Besides pre-war vs post-war, where else should we look for evidence to support each story?

Conquered — social unrest. Do franchise extensions happen in the wake of protests, riots, strikes, and the like?

Granted — public goods. Theory: mass electorate will demand public goods, so elite extends franchise when they become interested in public goods.

- Urbanization — public safety, infrastructure
- Public health — immunization, disease prevention, sanitation
- War prep also falls under here if fought for national security

Women's suffrage

Extension of the franchise to women doesn't really fit the Acemoglu and Robinson story — why not?

If most men already have the vote, extending to women doesn't change the rich-poor gap

So what *can* change for the elites in power from extending the franchise to women?

- Policy preferences: women voters might prioritize different public goods (e.g., temperance during the Progressive era)
- Partisan preferences: if women are systematically more conservative/liberal, could operate to one party's benefit

Data analysis

Przeworski's data collection

Annual data for 187 countries/dependencies

Dependent variable: Franchise extension in a given year

- Extended to lower-class men?
- Extended to women?

Independent variables:

- Pre-war/post-war period
- Prior social unrest
- Urbanization and infant mortality

Franchise extension events

Przeworski identifies 389 changes in national franchise policies

TABLE 1 *Franchise Reforms*

	To new suffrage category																			
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	21	22	31	32	41	42	51	52	61	62	71	72	All
From old suffrage category																				
0	5	11	8	21	2	18	27	1				2	2	2	2			1	47	149
1				6															1	7
2				6		3		2											3	14
3				5	6	3	2			1					1				1	19
4	1		7		4	3	17					3	1	1	2	1		1	11	52
5				3		1	3								7				3	17
6	1	2	4	6	2		5												5	25
7		1		6	2												1	6	36	52
21													1							1
22																			2	2
31											1									1
32																			1	1
41															1			2	2	5
42															2				2	4
51															1			1	1	3
52																	1		15	16
61																	1			1
62																			4	4
71							1												11	12
72					1							1					1	1		4
Total	7	14	19	53	17	25	58	1	2	1	1	6	4	3	16	1	4	12	145	389

Note: The row headings ('From old…') and the column headings ('To new…') indicate suffrage categories. These are: For males: 0 none; 1 estate representation; 2 property; 3 income and literacy; 4 income; 5 literacy or (income or literacy); 6 independent; 7 universal. For females: first digit gives qualifications for males; second digit: 1, indicates that women had to satisfy stricter requirements; second digit: 2, indicates that they qualified on the same basis as males. The cell entries count reforms of particular kinds.

Table 1 is so bad it nearly killed Claude

Claude Code thinking timeout and token output

Share

extract the tabular data from it as a text file?

Only include the 0-72 labeled rows/columns, then validate against the reported totals before spitting out the data

Meticulously reconciled tabular data alignment with reported column totals

The user wants me to extract the tabular data from this image of a table about franchise reforms. Let me carefully read the table and create a text file with the data, then validate against the reported row and column totals.

Let me parse this carefully.

Columns: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 21, 22, 31, 32, 41, 42, 51, 52, 61, 62, 71, 72, All

Rows (From old suffrage category): 0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 21, 22, 31, 32, 41, 42, 51, 52, 61, 62, 71, 72

Now I'm going through each row and extracting the values, treating blank cells as zeros. The first few rows show the pattern: row 0 has values across most columns totaling 149, row 1 is mostly empty with just a 6 and 1, row 2 has scattered values including a 3 and 2, and row 3 starts with mostly empty cells before a 5 and 6.

Continuing through row 4 which has more populated values including 1, 7, 4, 3, 17 and ends at 52, row 5 is sparse with just a few values like 3, 1, 3, and 7, row 6 has 1, 2, 4, 6, 2, 5 scattered throughout totaling 25, and row 7 has values like 1, 6, 2, 1, and 6 with a total of 52. I'm also noting that row 21 appears to be mostly empty. I'm looking at the rest of the data grid with the remaining rows and their distribution across columns, then compiling the totals to verify the counts add up correctly across all categories. Continuing to verify the row totals—rows 4 through 7 all check out, and I'm spot-checking a few more entries like rows 21 and 22 to make sure the "All" column is consistently calculated as the sum of the individual columns. Now I'm verifying the column totals and I'm noticing column 4 might not be adding up correctly—let me recount that one to make sure I haven't made an error. Looking at the column 4 totals, I'm getting 54 when I add up all the entries, but the reported total is 53—off by one somewhere. Let me reconsider how I'm reading row 7, since that might be where the discrepancy is. I'm recalculating column 4 by going through each row carefully, but I'm getting 54 when the reported total is 53—something's off by one. Let me work backwards from the correct total and figure out which cell I'm misreading, since the spacing in the image might be throwing off my column alignment. I'm trying to figure out which value is off by checking column 5 specifically—if row 5 has a different value there, or if row 6's entries are positioned differently than I thought, that could account for the missing sum. Let me systematically verify each row's contribution to column 5 to find where the discrepancy is. I'm testing whether one of the values I assigned to col4 actually belongs in col5 instead. If col5 needs to sum to 17 and currently has 16, I'm missing exactly 1 point, which means col4 is overcounted by 1. Let me figure out which single value needs to shift between these two columns. I think the issue is that the "1" in row 72 belongs in column 5 rather than column 4. Let me verify: if I move it to col5, then col4 totals to 53 and col5 to 17, both matching what they should be. The row sum stays at 4, so this adjustment works. Now I'll rebuild the full dataset with this correction and validate all the totals. I'm working through the column totals systematically to verify they all check out with the row 72 correction—columns 1 through 4 are confirmed, and now I'm checking column 5 and beyond to make sure everything adds up correctly. I'm wondering if I'm misreading row 0's value in column 6—let me double-check that entry since the numbers aren't adding up correctly for the column total. I'm trying to figure out the correct column assignments for row 4. The spacing suggests col1=1, col3=7, but I'm uncertain whether the 4 and 3 belong to columns 5 and 6 or columns 4 and 5, especially since 17 is clearly the largest value on the right side. Let me look at the raw sequence again to pin down the exact alignment. Looking at row 0 more carefully, I see the values 5, 11, 8, 21 clearl[illegible] to columns 1-4, then 2, 18, 27 should follow for columns 5-7, which gives a row total of 149 that [illegible]cks out. But placing 18 in column 6 creates a column total that's way too high, so I'm wondering if that 18 might actually be split across two columns or if I'm

Reply

Making sense of Table 1: Class extensions

From \ To	None	Estate	Property	Prop. + lit.	Prop./income	Lit./income	Independent	Universal M
None		5	12	8	25	6	18	75
Estate					6			1
Property			2		7		3	5
Prop. + lit.				2	5	7	3	4
Prop./income		1		7	4	10	4	35
Lit./income					3	8	2	23
Independent		1	2	4	6	2	1	14
Universal M			1		7	3	2	55

Making sense of Table 1: Gender extensions

(When) does war lead to democratization?

TABLE 3 *Final Specifications of Extensions (Marginal Effects, Probit Estimates)*

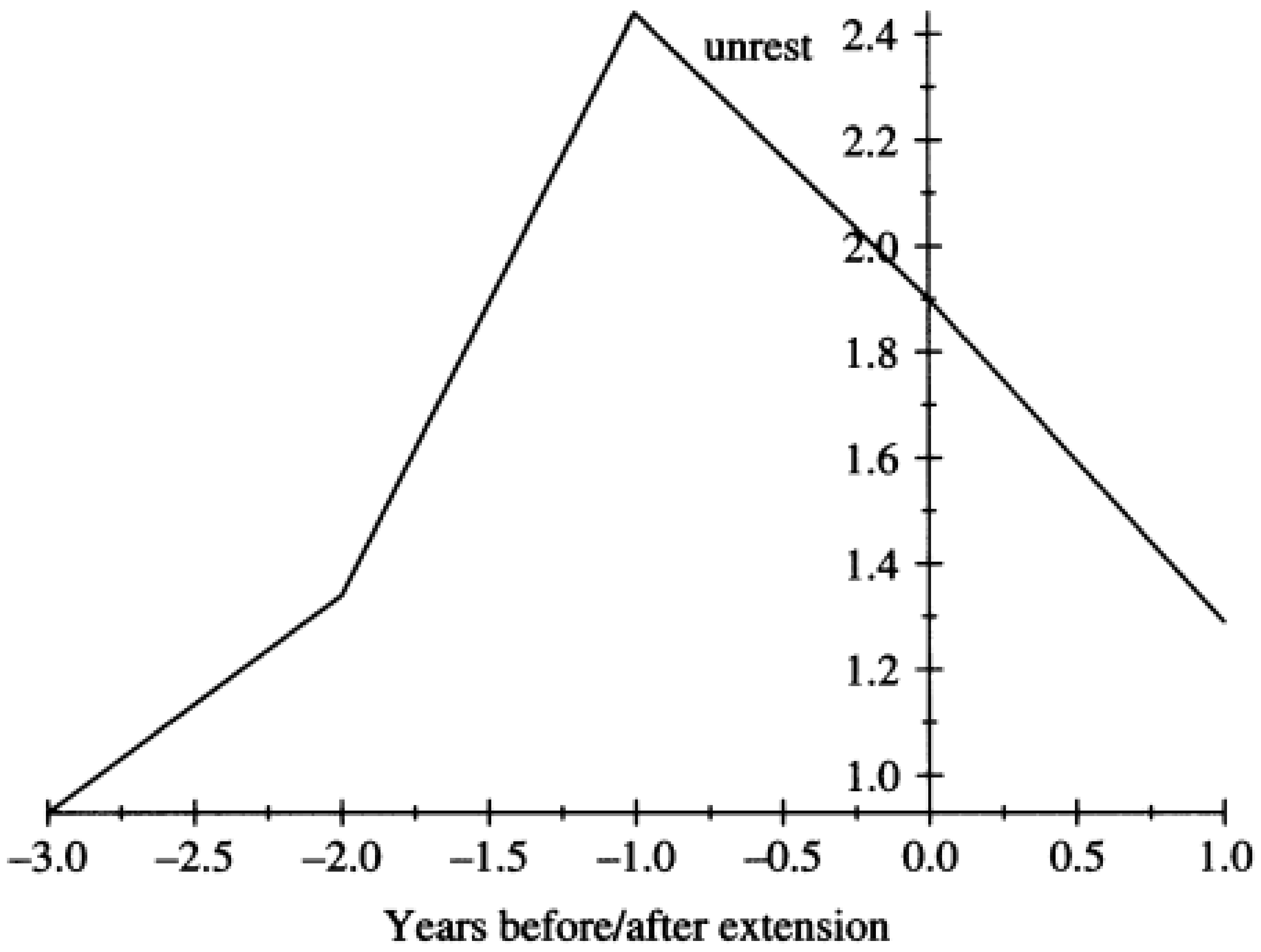
Extension	Any	Class	Gender	Both
Before war	0.0103	0.0084	−0.0041	−0.0005
	(0.0081)	(0.0122)	(0.0018)	(0.0017)
After war	0.03193***	0.0074	0.0197***	0.0214***
	(0.0119)	(0.0148)	(0.0064)	(0.0102)
Proportion	0.0742***	0.0412***	0.0244***	0.0031***
universal	(0.0113)	(0.0125)	(0.0042)	(0.0102)

Franchise extensions disproportionately likely in five years after war

Pre-war differences inconsistent, small, statistically insignificant

Conquered or granted?

Most consistent predictor of franchise extension is prior unrest

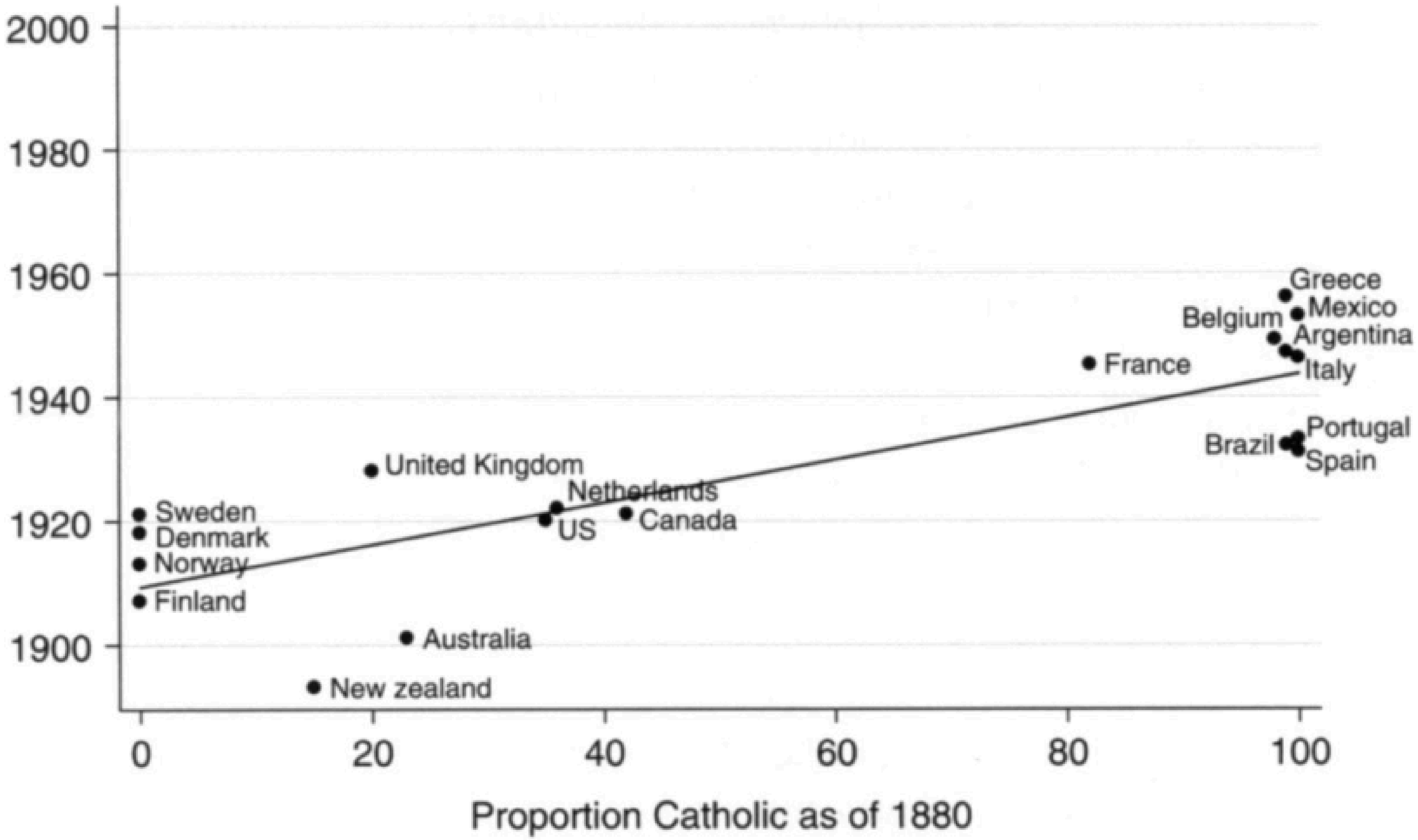


Apparent effects of urbanization/infant mortality are inconsistent

Inequality has *opposite* effect of A&R model (albeit holding unrest constant!)

What’s the deal with women’s suffrage?

Przeworski’s text tells a convoluted story about left and right parties and the precise timing to optimize suffrage grants for partisan advantage



His scatterplot tells a much simpler story to comprehend

Wrapping up

What we did today

1. Pre-war vs. post-war franchise expansion
2. Przeworski's framework: "conquered" vs. "granted"
    - Both are elite strategic choices — key difference is whether elites prefer the new status quo
    - Women's suffrage breaks the A&R logic — no redistributive threat
3. Data: "conquered" wins for class extensions
    - Unrest is the strongest predictor
    - War matters through its aftermath, not preparations

The rest of the week

Friday, 3:00–4:30pm. Seungho's office hours, Commons 3rd floor TA office.

Friday, 11:59pm. First draft of research paper due.

- I'll be monitoring my email through roughly 5pm Friday
- Really truly don't hesitate to reach out for help before then!

Monday. Read Blattman 2009, "From Violence to Voting: War and Political Participation in Uganda."